

**Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) &  
Networking and Information Technology Research and  
Development (NITRD) National Coordination Office (NCO)**

**Request for Information on the Development of  
an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan**

**Recommendations for the White House AI Action Plan**

**White Paper**

| Offeror                                                                                        |
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## I. SUMMARY

The rapid advancement of artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) presents significant opportunities and challenges for the U.S. national security agencies. One of the greatest challenges is keeping pace with the rapid evolution and advancements in AI, ML, digital, and data solutions space. Traditional government procurement practices are slow, complex, and often inaccessible to non-traditional technology providers. As a result, government agencies are often unable to tap into cutting-edge AI/ML capabilities with speed and efficiency. Moreover, as new and novel applications are identified, lengthy procurement processes and limited feedback loops hinder timely and effective engagement with potential non-traditional technology providers—further reducing the DOD’s potential for rapidly adopting cutting-edge technologies. *Without a modernized procurement framework for emerging technologies, the U.S. risks lagging adversaries in AI/ML adoption, putting national security and warfighters at risk.*

The Applied Research Institute, Inc (ARI) is pleased to submit a white paper to the Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) and Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National Coordination Office (NCO) with recommended actions for the development of the White House AI Action Plan. This white paper focuses on actions to accelerate government acquisition of cutting-edge AI/ML innovations based on proven application of novel techniques employed by the Department of Defense (DOD) Chief Digital and Artificial Intelligence Office’s (CDAO) Tradewinds Solutions Marketplace (TSM) program. For the past three years, ARI has served as the Solutions Marketplace Manager supporting CDAO in the development and prototyping of the TSM model for emerging AI, ML, digital and data capabilities. The TSM model has been proven to be a success, dramatically reducing procurement lead time, streamlining procurement processes to eliminate barriers to entry, and expanding DOD’s access to the best solutions from academia and industry. Building off the success of the Tradewinds Solutions Marketplace, the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) and US Air Force Platform One Office have implemented this acquisition model to serve their mission requirements. Broader adoption of the TSM model would revolutionize defense and government procurement by streamlining AI/ML acquisition, expanding the AI industrial base, and accelerating innovation adoption across DOD and Federal agencies.

## II. ABOUT THE TRADEWINDS SOLUTIONS MARKETPLACE

The CDAO TSM is a novel acquisition model for the rapid identification, assessment, adoption, and integration of emerging AI, ML, digital and data capabilities. TSM provides a digital **environment of post-competition, readily awardable, technology solution pitch videos (short, 5 min) for viewing by government agencies.** The introduction of TSM has transformed this landscape by establishing a streamlined assessment process for solutions, allowing for the rapid assessment, transparent feedback, and accelerated procurement of AI/ML, digital, and data solutions. Vendor-submitted video submissions, collected monthly, undergo a rigorous

competitive assessment process designed to align with multiple federal competition standards, statutes, regulations, and policies. By capturing post-competitive solutions in a user-friendly digital repository, the CDAO and its customer organizations gain access to new and novel solutions, validated for their technical merit, relevance, and impact, and prepositioned for rapid procurement. To learn more about TSM, visit [www.tradewindai.com](http://www.tradewindai.com).

TSM key features and benefits to the DOD and Federal agencies include:

- **Accelerating Acquisition Velocity** – TSM is delivering a novel agile contracting pathway that streamlines acquisition by eliminating redundant steps and enabling real-time government–industry collaboration. With an integrated feedback loop, procurement timelines are dramatically shortened—evidenced by an average Procurement Administrative Lead Time (PALT) of 56 days and select procurements completed in as few as 8 and 11 days—ensuring the warfighter receives timely, mission-critical capabilities.
- **TSM Software Acquisition Pathway** – The TSM process leverages Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) Authorities, Other Transaction Authorities (OTA), and Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) authorities concurrently to maximize flexibility and allow for all congressionally issued authorities to be employed simultaneously. All Adaptive Acquisition Pathways are available, including the Software Acquisition Pathway. The CSO to OTA to Software Acquisition Pathway has been an integrated approach since the inception of the TSM in November 2022.
- **Streamlined Procurement Process** – TSM leverages existing acquisition authorities to their fullest, obviating the need for new regulations or authorities. By fully aligning with FAR, DFARS, and DoD CSO and OTA standards, the TSM minimizes administrative overhead, enabling both government and industry to concentrate on accelerating innovative AI/ML, digital, and data solutions that close critical mission gaps. *This process eliminates unnecessary and potentially duplicative bureaucratic processes, accelerating the contracting process by 250%.* **Figure 1.0** outlines the TSM procurement process.



Figure 1.0 TSM Streamlined Procurement Process

- **Broad Access to Critical Technologies** – The TSM serves as a dynamic, centralized hub that continuously showcases state-of-the-art technologies tailored for defense applications. With an ever-evolving catalog of next-generation capabilities, defense stakeholders from 47 government organizations gain real-time access to breakthrough innovations—empowering rapid adoption of critical solutions. New capabilities are added to the available pool of cutting-edge AI/ML, Digital, and Data solutions on a monthly basis.

### III. POLICY ACTIONS

ARI presents the following policy recommendations for consideration.

#### 1. Establish a Government-wide Solutions Marketplace for AI/ML:

- Build on the success of the TSM and expand to create a centralized, continuously updated repository of pre-vetted, post-competition, AI/ML, digital and data solutions for rapid procurement across all Federal Agencies.
- Model this Marketplace after the TSM utilizing the following features:
  1. A searchable repository of cutting-edge AI/ML capabilities for Federal government agencies.
  2. Vendor-friendly submission processes, such as short-form video pitches and rolling admissions, to lower barriers for entry.
  3. Provide transparent and structured feedback loops to help vendors refine solutions and better meet government needs.
  4. Conduct continuous outreach to encourage participation from both small businesses, startups, and non-traditional contractors, as well as with DOD and Federal government agencies.
  5. Conduct weekly office hours and education sessions with industry and government stakeholders.
  6. Develop standardized workflows, acquisition templates, and decision support tools to facilitate rapid adoption and acquisition.
  7. Establish a dedicated helpdesk for AI/ML procurement, technical validation, and regulatory compliance support.

#### 2. Endorse the Solutions Marketplace for AI/ML as a Software Acquisition Pathway:

- Issue a Memorandum endorsing the Solutions Marketplace model for AI/ML as a viable acquisition model that supports the DOD and Federal Government Software Acquisition Pathways. This memo would provide support needed to acquisition organizations that are looking for approval to use the Marketplace Model instead of traditional acquisition authorities.

#### 3. Ensure Long Term Sustainability of the Solutions Marketplace for AI/ML:

- Establish an AI Task Force to oversee implementation of the Government-Wide Solutions Marketplace.
- Provide funding to support implementation of the Government-Wide Solutions Marketplace, as well as provide for continuous execution and maintenance.

#### **IV. EXPECTED IMPACT**

By adopting a Government-Wide Solutions Marketplace model, the DOD and U.S. government will:

- Significantly reduce AI/ML procurement timelines from months to weeks.
- Expand DOD and Federal Government access to cutting-edge AI/ML solutions.
- Strengthen national security by rapidly equipping agencies with mission-critical capabilities.
- Enhance collaboration between government, industry, and academia.

#### **V. CONCLUSION**

The White House AI Action Plan must prioritize agile AI/ML procurement mechanisms to maintain technological leadership. By leveraging the proven success of the TSM model, the proposed Government-Wide Solutions Marketplace will drive efficiency, foster innovation, and ensure the government remains at the forefront of AI/ML adoption.

#### **Applied Research Institute, Inc.**

Applied Research Institute, Inc. (ARI) is an Indiana-based, 501(c)(3) nonprofit leader in technology innovation and strategy. As a neutral, third-party innovation ecosystem orchestrator, ARI collaborates with cross-sectional partners from state and federal government, industry, and academia across a wide spectrum of technology focus areas. What sets ARI apart is our expert-informed, practitioner-driven approach to innovation—an approach proven through pioneering prototypes like Tradewinds and DARPAConnect. Combining deep subject matter expertise in areas such as acquisition with state-of-the-art technologies enables us to execute tangible pathways that empower innovators to secure awards and fill mission gaps for the warfighter. In doing so, ARI transforms innovative ideas into operational capabilities that have a direct and lasting impact on both national defense and economic prosperity. Learn more at [www.theari.us](http://www.theari.us).